

Unhealthy relationships

When someone's behavior toward another person doesn't exhibit respect, equality, safety, and trust, something is wrong with that relationship. Sometimes, the "unhealthy" behavior is one-sided. In other couples, both people behave badly.

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What is an unhealthy relationship?

Unhealthy relationships don't have the crucial elements of respect, equality, trust, and safety that make a relationship strong. In an unhealthy relationship, these elements are either not there or they are false. A relationship can also be unhealthy if these things come with conditions, exceptions, or pressures. These behaviors and attitudes make the relationship unhealthy and have a negative impact on the other person in that relationship.

GOOD TO KNOW

Controlling communication

If a friend or partner wants to monitor or check your text messages, emails, or social media, then there's a problem in the relationship, as the crucial elements of respect, equality, trust, and safety are not present. No one has the right to control your communication or limit the people you communicate with.

I read your diary—I can't believe what you wrote about me!



lack of respect

You're so bad at choosing movies, I'll do it.



lack of equality

I can't believe you told me that! I'm going to tell everyone.



lack of trust

I'm so angry, I could break something!



lack of safety

▷ Unhealthy signs

If one or all of these negative traits exist in a relationship, it makes the whole relationship unhealthy and bad for the people in it.